

STRIVE ACADEMY

1st Grade Complete School Blueprint

APA Scope Preserved + Strive Adaptive Learning Protocol Applied

What This Blueprint Is

This is a source-preserving school blueprint. The front pages explain how to operate the grade through Strive Academy. The appendix contains the original APA curriculum transparency pages in full, so the school scope is not lost or watered down.

Use this as the control document for building weekly lessons, mission reports, AI-generated modules, teacher checklists, parent communication, and student mastery dashboards.

Non-Negotiable Scope Rule

- Do not replace the APA/Core Knowledge/Utah Core scope with vague themes.
- Every unit, book, poem, song, saying, math strand, science topic, grammar/vocabulary program, intensive group option, and resource listed in the appendix must be either scheduled, taught, or intentionally documented as not used.
- Strive adapts delivery: pacing, modality, mastery checks, mission framing, retrieval, project work, and reflection.
- The appendix is the audit trail. The Strive layer is the operating system.

Grade Mission Arcs

Arc	Mission Name	APA Content Pulled In	Mastery Artifact
1	World Map Cadets	continents, countries, maps, communities	Mission report + retrieval score + project/skill proof
2	Ancient Civilization Quest	Mesopotamia, Ancient Egypt, early civilizations	Mission report + retrieval score + project/skill proof
3	Story Galaxy	classic tales, fairy tales, fables, drama, poetry	Mission report + retrieval score + project/skill proof
4	Living Earth Lab	living things, habitats, oceans, Earth and astronomy	Mission report + retrieval score + project/skill proof
5	Foundations of Number	patterns, number sense, computation, money, geometry, measurement	Mission report + retrieval score + project/skill proof

Strive Delivery Crosswalk

APA Blueprint Area	Strive Conversion	Required Evidence
Reading / Literature / Poetry	Reading Quest, speed-read passages, comprehension quests, oral narration, literature discussions	Fluency log, comprehension answers, teach-back, poem recitation/analysis
Writing / Grammar / Spelling / Vocabulary	Word Lab and Writing Mission using Shurley, Wordly Wise/Spalding/A.I.L./Writing & Rhetoric as listed	Sentence analysis, spelling/vocab retrieval, paragraph/essay/report output
Math	Math Arena with concept lesson, fact drill, worked problems, manipulatives, and mastery checks	Worked examples, fact fluency, 80-90% mastery check
Science	Science Bay: observe, diagram, model, experiment, explain	Science notebook, diagram/model, lab output, oral explanation
History / Geography / Civics	History Expedition: maps, timelines, source stories, discussion, debate, narration	Map/timeline, narration, discussion response, short writing
Art / Music	Flight Training: connect art/music to the same theme when possible	Performance, artwork, song/artist/composer note
Logic / Economics / Character	Logic Deck, Tuttle Twins where assigned, virtue/character mission, reflection	Puzzle result, scenario response, character reflection

Standard Weekly Build Pattern

Day	Mission Move	Retrieval Requirement	Output
Monday	WHY hook + introduce source scope	Review last week + pretest key vocab	Mission plan + first notes
Tuesday	WHAT direct instruction	Flashcards / oral recall	3 key ideas + examples
Wednesday	HOW practice lab	Mixed review from Mon/Tue	Skill practice or model
Thursday	WHAT IF transfer	Cumulative mini quiz	Project, debate, writing, or design
Friday	MASTERY check + Kaizen debrief	Teach-back + spaced review	Scorecard + weekly report

Lesson-Level Template

4MAT Step	Prompt	Student Evidence
WHY	Why does this matter in real life, faith, family, community, history, or future work?	1-3 sentence answer or oral response
WHAT	What are the facts, vocabulary, rules, dates, people, processes, or patterns?	Notes, definitions, diagram, narration
HOW	How do I do it, solve it, classify it, write it, map it, build it, or explain it?	Completed practice / demonstration
WHAT IF	What if the idea changed, disappeared, failed, scaled, or showed up somewhere else?	Transfer question or creative challenge
MASTERY	Can I retrieve it later and teach it clearly?	Quiz, teach-back, project, corrected errors

Student Supports

Learner Need	Built-In Support	School Rule
ADHD	Short chunks, timers, movement responses, mission language, visible progress	Traction beats lecture. Keep lessons moving.
Dyslexia	Audio/read-aloud option, larger print, oral teach-back, less copying when needed	Measure mastery, not copying endurance.
Autism / anxiety	Predictable routine, explicit examples, clear transitions, direct expectations	Clarity is kindness.
Advanced learner	What If extension, leadership role, deeper research, project challenge	Do not punish fast mastery with busywork.

School Leader Checklist

- Before each quarter: mark which appendix source items will be taught in each mission arc.
- Before each week: write the Mission Theme, Big Question, vocabulary/skill targets, and mastery artifact.
- Daily: require retrieval practice, not just exposure.
- Weekly: review scores, missing work, behavior notes, and reflection data.
- Monthly: run a Kaizen review and improve weak lessons.

Appendix A Begins Next - Original APA Curriculum Pages

The following pages are the original uploaded APA curriculum transparency/overview document for this grade. They are attached in full as the scope-control appendix. Use them as the checklist while designing lessons and school operations.

1st Grade Curriculum Overview

American Preparatory Academy follows Utah Core Standards as well as following the Core Knowledge Sequence as outlined in *What Your First Grader Needs to Know*.

- Utah Core Standards for 1st Grade can be found at: <https://www.uen.org/core/>
- Core Knowledge Sequence can be found at: <https://www.coreknowledge.org/>
- [*What Your First Grader Needs to Know*](#) by E. D. Hirsch Jr. (ISBN 978-0553392388)
 - [*What Your First Grader Needs to Know*](#) offers parents, teachers, and students an illustrated guide to the essential knowledge outlined in the Core Knowledge Sequence, including stories and poems, familiar sayings, interesting information on history and geography, discussions of visual arts and music, and explanations and activities in math and science.

Subjects taught at APA in 1st Grade include:

[Art](#)

[Grammar](#)

[History/Geography](#)

[Language Arts](#)

[Literature](#)

[Logic/Comprehension](#)

[Music](#)

[Poetry](#)

[Reading University](#)

[Sayings and Phrases](#)

[Science](#)

[Spelling](#)

[Writing](#)

[1st Grade Conceptual](#)

[Math](#)

1st Grade Curriculum Overview

Homeroom Subjects

Art

Art projects are chosen for students based on the Core Knowledge Curriculum as found in: *What Your First Grader Needs to Know* (2014 Revised Edition) by E. D. Hirsch Jr. (ISBN 978-0553392388)

Grammar

The Shurley Method Level 1 Teacher's Manual by Shurley, Brenda & Wetsell, Ruth 1997 Second Edition (ISBN 978-1-881940-65-4)

History

History, [*What Your First Grader Needs to Know*](#) by E. D. Hirsch Jr. (ISBN 978-0553392388)

- Communities
- Ice Age
- Mesopotamia
- Ancient Egypt
- World Religions
- Early Civilizations
- English Settlers
- American Revolution
- American Symbols
- American West
- Mexico

History Resources:

Literature excerpts found from core knowledge resources:

[1st Grade History Core Knowledge Literature](#)

- Unit 1: Continents, Countries, and Maps
- Unit 2: Mesopotamia
- Unit 3: Ancient Egypt
- Unit 4: Three World Religions
- Unit 5: Early Civilizations of the Americas
- Unit 6: The Culture of Mexico
- Unit 7: Early Explorers and Settlers
- Unit 8: From Colonies to Independence
- Unit 9: Exploring the West
- Unit 10: Lessons in Civics

1st Grade Curriculum Overview

Language Arts

[Heggerty Phonemic Awareness by Michael Heggerty](#)

ISBN 978-1-947-260-43-6

Literature

Literature books in 2nd Grade include the following:

Literature all excerpts from: [*What Your First Grader Needs to Know*](#) by E. D. Hirsch Jr. (ISBN 978-0553392388)

- All Stories Are Anansi's
- The Boy at the Dike
- Brer Rabbit Gets Brer Fox's Dinner
- The Frog Prince
- Hansel and Gretel
- In Which Tigger Comes to the Forest and Has Breakfast
- Issun Boshi: One-Inch Boy
- Tom Thumb
- The Crowded, Noisy House
- Jack and the Beanstalk
- The Knee-High Man
- The Little Half-Chick (Medio Pollito)
- The Pied Piper of Hamelin
- Pinocchio
- The Princess and the Pea
- Puss-in-Boots
- Rapunzel
- Rumpelstiltskin
- Sleeping Beauty
- The Tale of Peter Rabbit
- Why the Owl Has Big Eyes
- The Boy Who Cried Wolf: A Drama

Logic/Comprehension

[Language for Thinking by Siegfried Engelmann - ISBN: 0026848856](#)

1st Grade Curriculum Overview

Music

Music selections are chosen for students based on the Core Knowledge Curriculum as found in:

[*What Your First Grader Needs to Know*](#) by E. D. Hirsch Jr. (ISBN 978-0553392388)

- Melody, Harmony, and Rhythm
- Meet a Great Composer
- Mozart the Wonder Boy
- Mozart, a Famous Composer
- Reading and Writing Music
- Instruments and Their Families
- The Orchestra
- Music Can Tell a Story
- Move to the Music
- A Ballet About a Nutcracker
- Jazz: America's Musical Gift to the World
- Songs
 - *Star Spangled Banner* (verses one and four) by Francis Scott Key
 - *America the Beautiful*
 - *La Cucaracha (The Cockroach)*
 - *Blow the Man Down*
 - *Billy Boy*
 - *Down by the Riverside*
 - *For He's a Jolly Good Fellow*
 - *Down in the Valley*
 - *Dry Bones*
 - *Frere Jacques/Brother John*
 - *Michael, Row the Boat Ashore*
 - *She'll Be Comin' 'Round the Mountain*
 - *Skip to My Lou*
 - *There's a Hole in the Bucket*
 - *Take Me Out to the Ball Game*

1st Grade Curriculum Overview

Poetry

Poems will be memorized or analyzed. These poems are from What Your 1st Grader Needs to Know (CK)

- *Builders* by Anonymous
- *Little Sally Walker*
- *The Queen of Hearts*
- *If Wishes Were Horses*
- *Three Wise Men of Gotham*
- *Solomon Grundy*
- *Thirty Days Hath September*
- *Tongue Twisters*
- *Riddle Rhymes*
- *The Pasture* by Robert Frost
- *Hope* by Langston Hughes
- *A Good Play* by Robert Louis Stevenson
- *The Swing* by Robert Louis Stevenson
- *The Frog* by Hilaire Belloc
- *The Owl and the Pussy-Cat* by Edward Lear
- *The Purple Cow* by Gelett Burgess
- *I Know All the Sounds That the Animals Make* by Jack Prelutsky
- *My Shadow* by Robert Louis Stevenson
- *Rope Rhyme* by Eloise Greenfield
- *Table Manners* by Gelett Burgess
- *Sing a Song of People* by Lois Lenski
- *Washington* by Nancy Byrd Turner
- *Wynken, Blynken, and Nod* by Eugene Field
- *Thanksgiving Day* by Lydia Maria Child

Reading University

Reading University books for all grades can be viewed at:

<https://www.americanprep.org/reading-university/>

- A list of books for first grade will be available separate from this packet.

Sayings and Phrases

- *An apple a day keeps the doctor away*
- *Never leave till tomorrow what you can do today*

1st Grade Curriculum Overview

- *Don't judge a book by its cover*
- *Do unto other as you would have them do unto you*
- *Hit the nail on the head*
- *If at first you don't succeed, try, try again*
- *Land of Nod*
- *Let the cat out of the bag*
- *The more the merrier*
- *Practice makes perfect*
- *There's no place like home*

Science

Lessons for science are created by A.P.A. staff and are based on the Utah SEED standards, along with the Core Knowledge Sequence. These lessons will include the following topics:

- Living Things
- Habitats
- Helping Habitats
- Oceans
- Body Systems
- Germs
- Matter
- Electricity
- Measurement
- Astronomy
- Earth

Spelling

[The Writing Road to Reading by Romalda Bishop Spalding](#) ISBN13 978-0688100070

1st Grade Curriculum Overview

Writing

Adventures in Language (A.I.L.):

- [Adventures in Language by Terry Dodd, Fay Goodfellow, Dawn Dodds](#)

Informational Writing & Book report lessons are created by A.P.A. staff and are based on the Utah Core standards, along with the Core Knowledge Sequence.

1st Grade Conceptual Math

Lessons for 1st grade Core Math are created by A.P.A. staff and are based on the [Utah Core Standards](#), along with the Core Knowledge Sequence. These lessons will include the following topics:

- Patterns and Classifications
- Numbers and Number Sense
- Computation
- Money
- Geometry
- Measurement

1st Grade Curriculum Overview

Intensive Groups Curriculum

Intensive Reading Groups

[Take Flight: A Comprehensive Intervention for Students with Dyslexia](#) by Luke Waites
Waites Center for Dyslexia and Learning Disorders at Scottish Rite for Children

Reading Mastery, by Siegfried Engelmann and Jean Osborn

- For each *Reading Mastery* level (see list below), students will use a textbook, a workbook, and a skillbook. These books can be purchased on amazon.com or checked out in the school curriculum room.

Reading Mastery 1

Reading Mastery 2

Once the curriculum is completed a novel is read to finish the school year.

Novels:

- *Amelia Bedelia Play Ball* by Peggy Parish
- *Nate the Great* by Marjorie W. Sharmat
- *Dinosaurs Before Dark* by Mary Pope Osborne
- *Kidnapped at Birth* by Louis Sachar
- *Junie B Jones and the Stupid Smelly Bus* by Barbara Park
- *Sprite's Secret* by Tracey West

Reading Mastery 3

Novels:

- *The Boxcar Children* by Gertrude Chandler Warner
- *Charlotte's Web* by E.B. White
- *Enormous Egg* by Oliver Butterworth
- *Stone Fox* by John Reynolds Gardner

Reading Mastery 4

Novels:

- *Ramona Quimby* by Beverly Cleary
- *Ben and Me* by Robert Lawson
- *Old Yeller* by Fred Gibson

1st Grade Curriculum Overview

- *Little House in the big Woods* by Laura Ingalls Wilder
- *Sadako and the Thousand Paper Cranes* by Eleanor Coerr
- *Stuart Little* by E.B. White

Intensive Math Groups

Based on assessment data, students will be assigned to one of the following math classes. For each *CMC* level (see list below), students will use a textbook and a math facts/worksheet practice book. These books can be purchased on amazon.com or checked out in the school curriculum room.

- *SRA Connecting Math Concepts A (CMC A)*, McGraw Hill
- *SRA Connecting Math Concepts B (CMC B)*, McGraw Hill
- *SRA Connecting Math Concepts C (CMC C)*, McGraw Hill
- *SRA Connecting Math Concepts D (CMC D)*, McGraw Hill
- *Saxon Math (5/4)*, by Stephen Hake and John Saxon
 - For each Saxon Math Level, students will use a textbook and a math facts practice book. These books can be purchased on amazon.com or checked out in the school curriculum room.